



## How Humanoid Robots Are Transforming Media Industry

AI is a valuable tool for both editorial and production teams in the publishing industry. It reduces human journalists' workload and allows them to spend more time on other important stories



Fig. 1: Xin Xiaomeng, the world's first female humanoid news anchor  
(Credit: <http://en.people.cn>)

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**A**rtificial intelligence (AI) is taking away jobs in many industries, and media and entertainment are no exception. This article covers the latest trends of how AI is transforming the field of media, including TV news reporting, journalism and publishing.

Xin Xiaomeng, the world's first female AI news anchor (Fig. 1) was unveiled in China and hit TV screens in February 2019. It was developed by Xinhua News Agency and Chinese search engine Sogou.com. They used machine learning to simulate voice, facial movements and gestures of real-life broadcasters, to present a life-like image instead of a cold robot. In November 2018, they unveiled

two male AI news anchors: one for English news and the other for Chinese news.

Xinhua and Sogou have also built an improved male AI news anchor named Xin Xiaohao. He has greater body language capabilities, such as an increased number of hand gestures and facial expressions. He can also present news in a standing position, as opposed to other AI anchors, all of whom are programmed in sitting positions. These robots are basically *avatars* and cloned from real-life hosts, and have mastered broadcasting. These news anchors learn from live videos, read texts and are able to work 24/7, reporting via social media and on specific websites.

Prior to Xin Xiaomeng, Japan unveiled Kodomoroid, a female news presenter at an exhibition at Miraikan (National Museum of Emerging Science and Innovation in Tokyo, Japan) in 2014. It has thirty degrees of freedom, and can express various facial expressions and gestural motions.

Russia has also introduced a robot TV anchor named Alex. However, Alex can only move his facial features and neck.

Humanoid robot called Rashmi has been developed recently in India. She is the first Hindi-speaking robot and has been hosting a show on Red FM since 2018.

### Digital publishing

Digital publishing or electronic publishing includes publication of e-books and digital magazines that are mostly meant to be read on a screen such as computer, e-reader, tablet or smartphone. It also includes editorial aspects, development of digital libraries and catalogues.